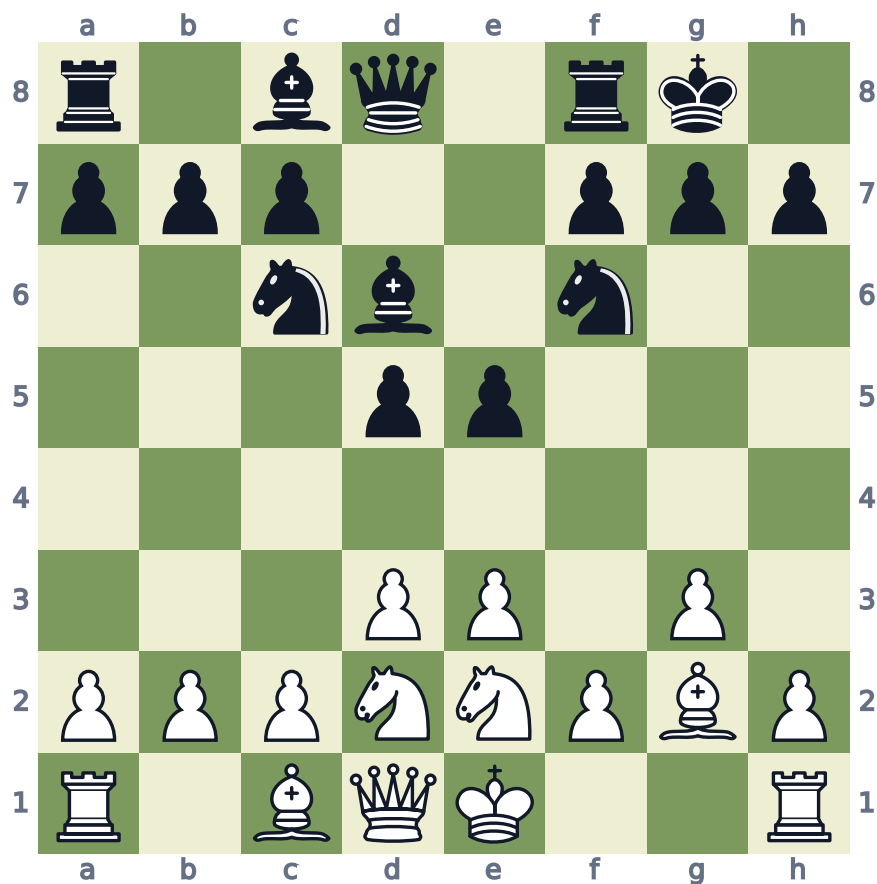


White Hippo vs e5 and Open-Center Systems

Single-pawn centers, rapid development, f5 aggression, checks, and open files



Handle Black's e5 systems with sound development and know when the position is too open for leisurely Hippo maneuvering.

8 learning units | solid-piece diagrams | recall tests | engine checks

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Handle Black's e5 systems with sound development and know when the position is too open for leisurely Hippo maneuvering.

THE WHITE HIPPO TRAINING LOOP

- Identify Black's center, both kings, and Black's most forcing pawn break.
- At every diagram compare e4, d4, c4, and f4 before choosing another setup move.
- Hide the answer until you have spoken the move, purpose, and Black's best reply.
- Replay each branch from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 8 units inside a connected 1.g3 repertoire. It teaches setup, exceptions, transformation, and resulting plans; the companion PGNs make later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

A single e5 pawn can be attacked with d4 or restrained with e4.

PRINCIPLE 2

Open centers reward king safety and development more than slow flank moves.

PRINCIPLE 3

Black's early f5 creates targets but also immediate threats.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

A check or center capture overrides completion of the shell.

PRINCIPLE 5

The g2 bishop becomes powerful when the center opens on the long diagonal.

PRINCIPLE 6

White should transpose into an open game when that is the clearest route.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 1-8

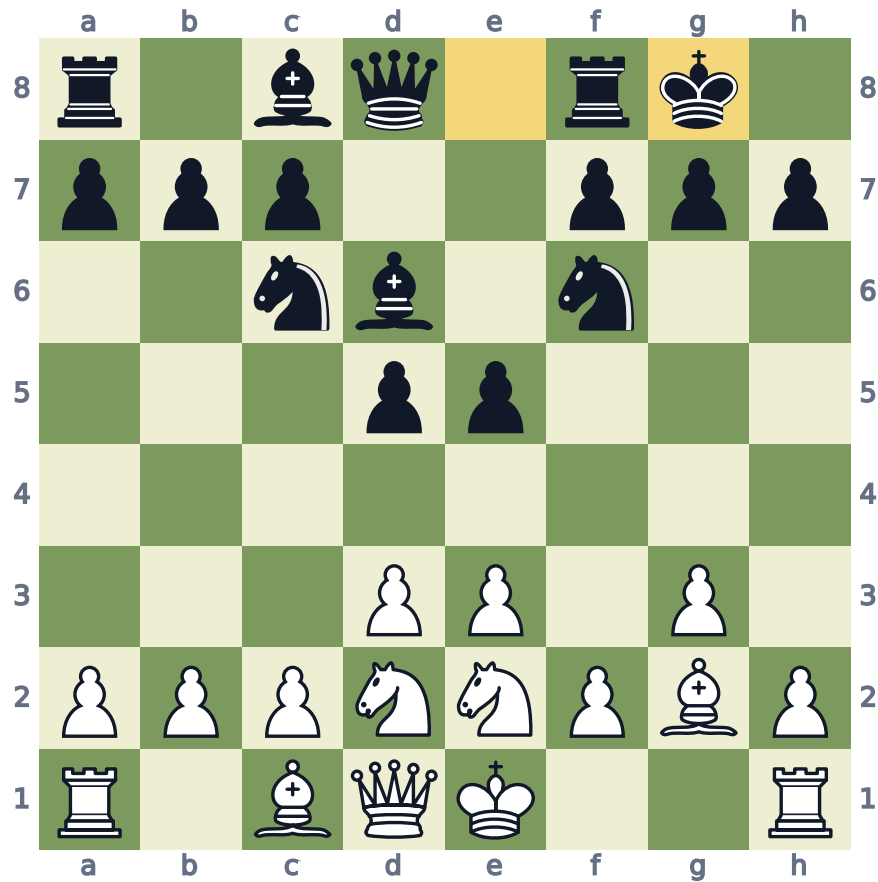
- | | | |
|-----------|---------------------------------------|--|
| 01 | Single e5 with d4 challenge | The less support e5 has, the more attractive d4 becomes. |
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 | | |
| 02 | Black develops Bc5 | Open-center systems reward king safety before flank moves. |
|
 | | |
| 03 | Early f5 with e4 restraint | Against f5, stop the pawn chain from rolling before adding b3. |
|
 | | |
| 04 | e5-d6 compact center | A compact black center permits e4, but the next break still matters. |
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 | | |
| 05 | e5 with h5 | Do not answer a wing pawn until it creates a concrete threat. |
|
 | | |
| 06 | Open contact on e4 | When the d-file opens, calculate the complete queen-exchange sequence. |
|
 | | |
| 07 | Accept the early f-pawn target | Winning a pawn is secondary to completing development. |
|
 | | |
| 08 | Meet Bb4 pressure | A pin is urgent only when it supports a central tactic. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 01

Single e5 with d4 challenge



COURSE LINE

1. g3 e5 2. Bg2 Nf6 3. d3 Nc6 4. Nd2 d5 5. e3 Bd6 6. Ne2 O-O

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

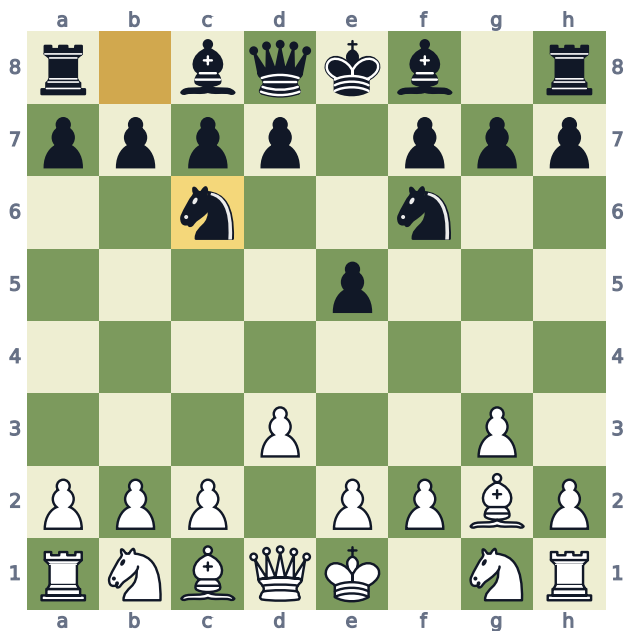
Prepare d4 and develop rapidly against a single central pawn.

MAIN DANGER

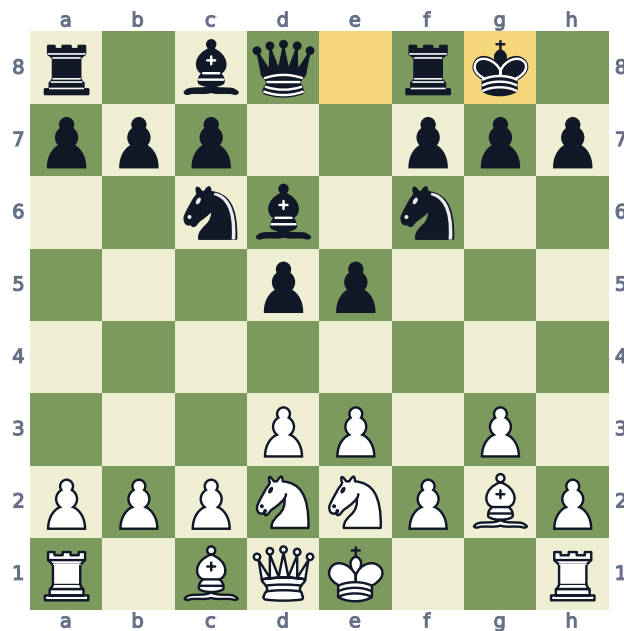
e4 can gain space if White delays.

BRANCH LOGIC 01

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

The less support e5 has, the more attractive d4 becomes.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

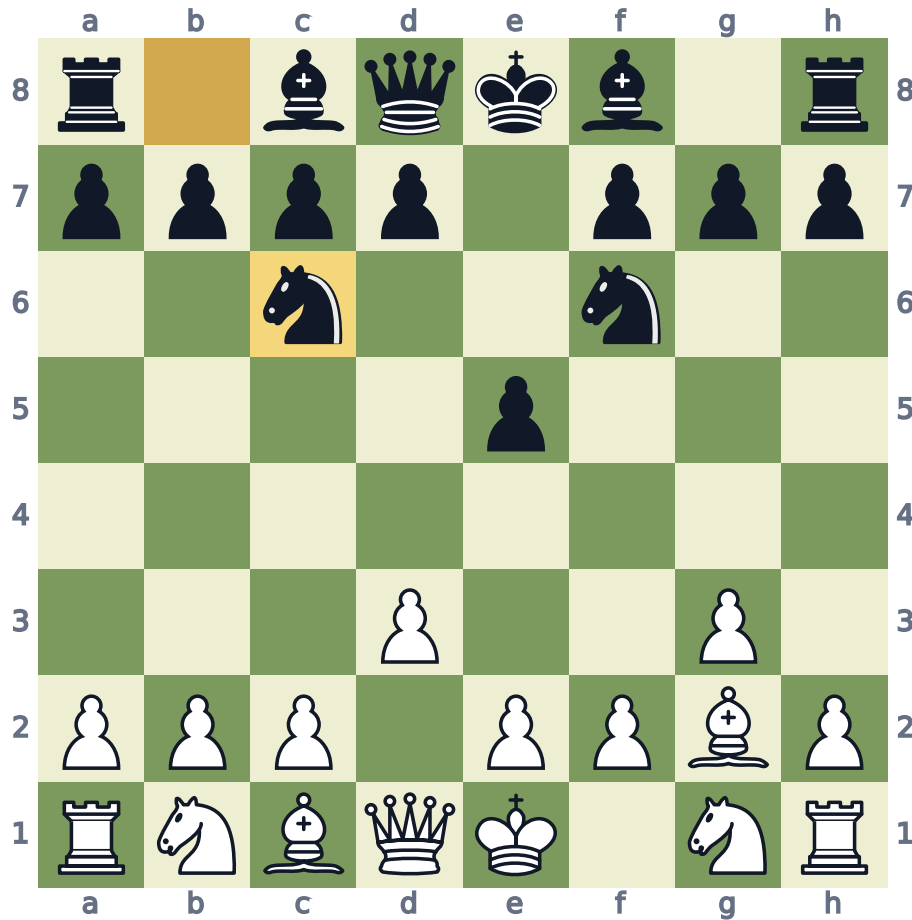
Position estimate: -0.50 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. O-O Ne7 2. c4 c6 3. e4 h6 4. exd5 cxd5 5. d4 exd4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 01

Single e5 with d4 challenge



YOUR TASK

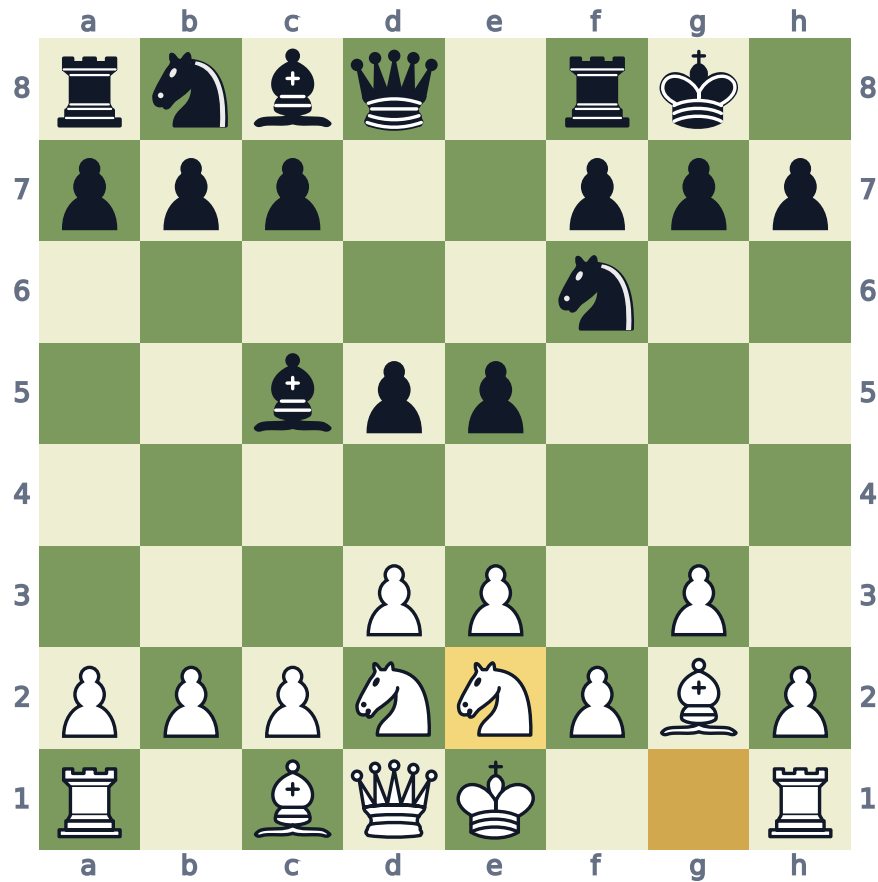
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 02

Black develops Bc5



COURSE LINE

1. g3 e5 2. Bg2 Nf6 3. d3 Bc5 4. e3 O-O 5. Nd2 d5 6. Ne2

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

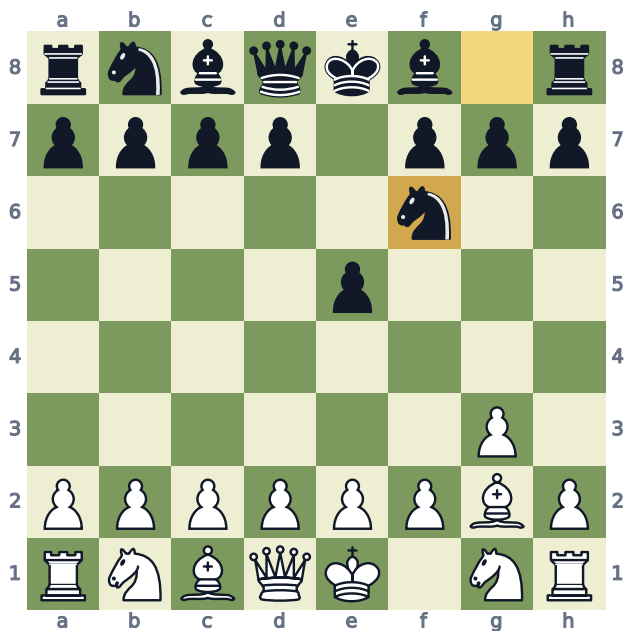
Prepare d4 without exposing the king to a central tactic.

MAIN DANGER

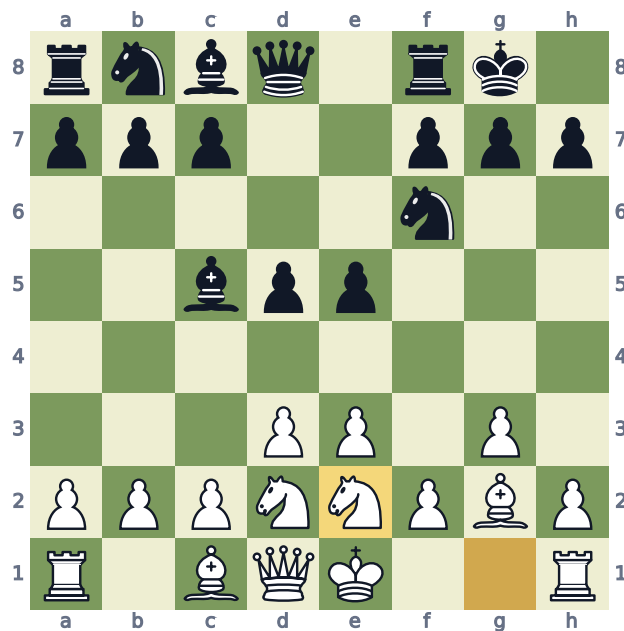
Ng4 and d4 can create pressure before White castles.

BRANCH LOGIC 02

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Open-center systems reward king safety before flank moves.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

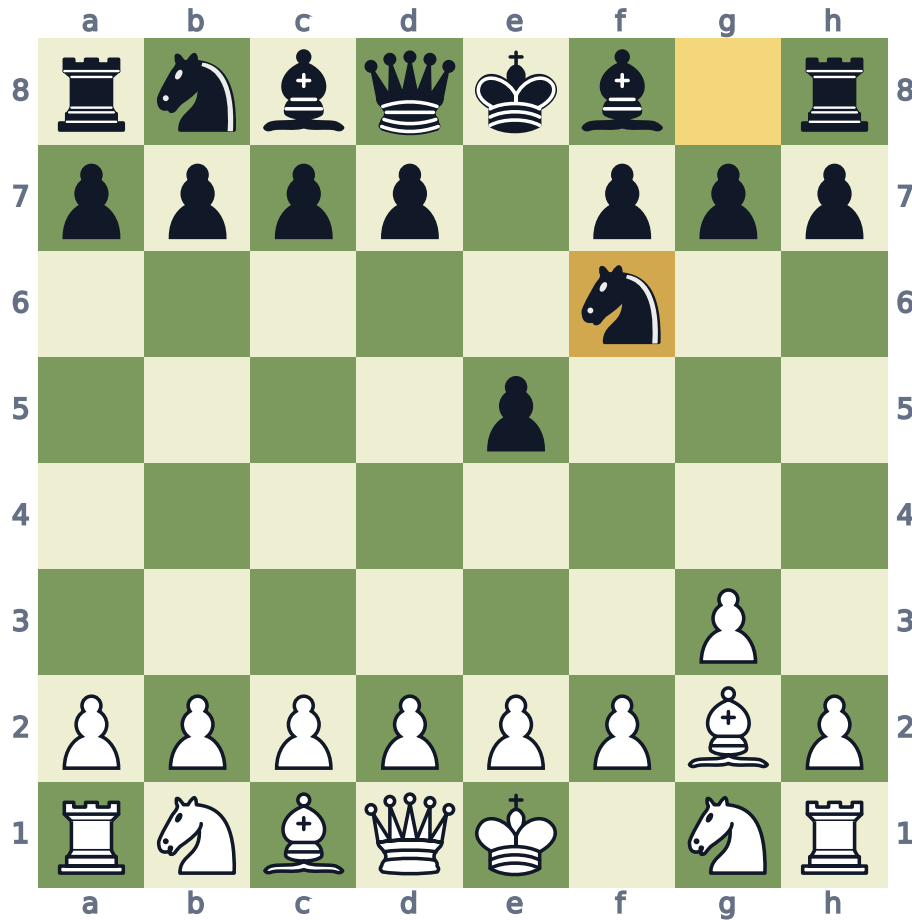
Position estimate: -0.61 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Re8 a3 2. a5 b3 3. Bf5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 02

Black develops Bc5



YOUR TASK

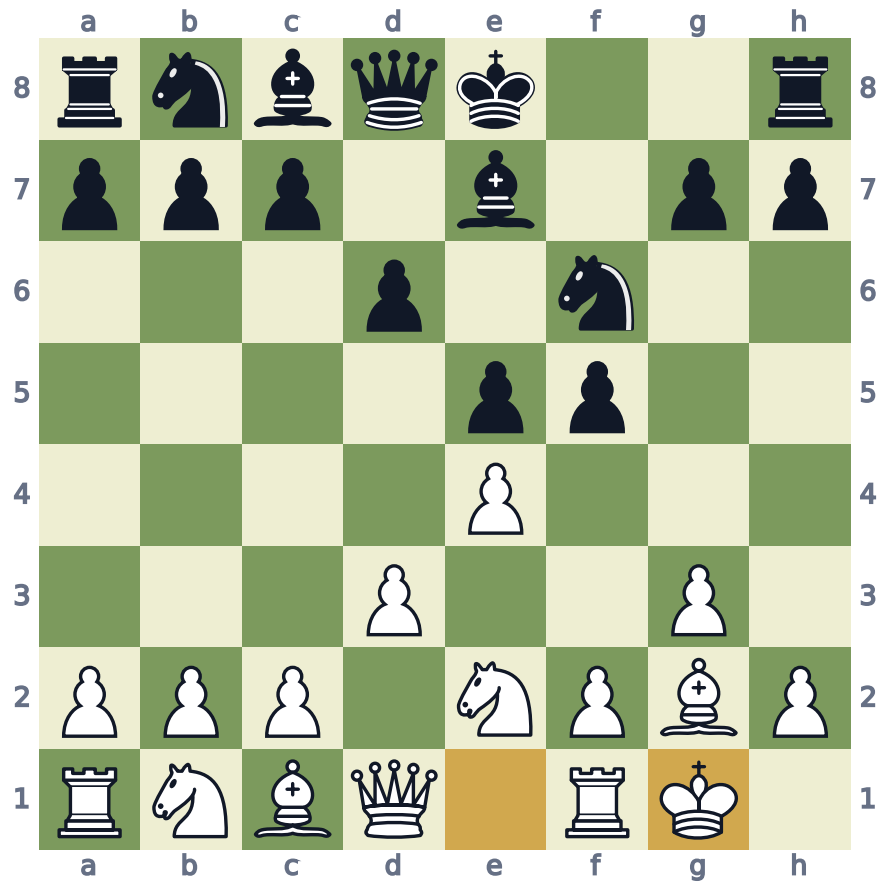
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 03

Early f5 with e4 restraint



COURSE LINE

1. g3 e5 2. Bg2 f5 3. d3 Nf6 4. e4 d6 5. Ne2 Be7 6. O-O

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

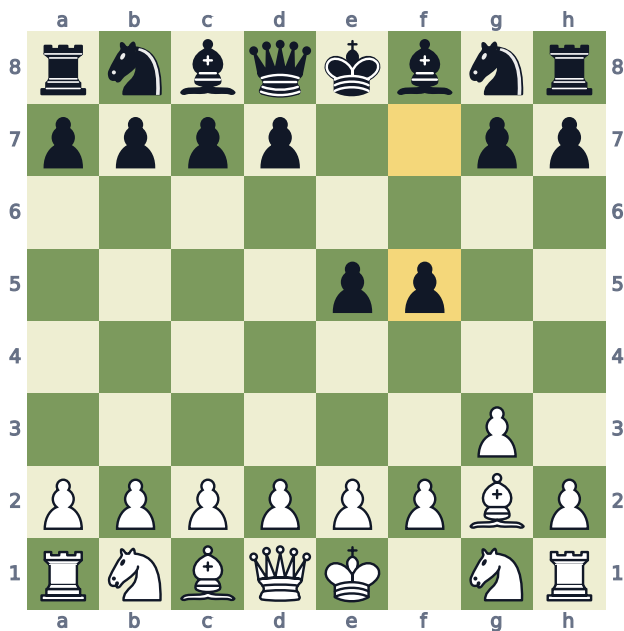
Use e4 to block the f-pawn's support and prepare f4 or exf5.

MAIN DANGER

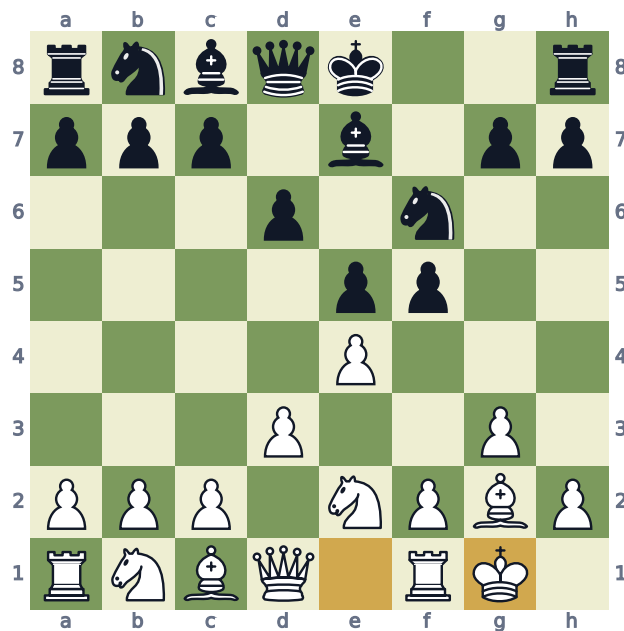
fxe4 can open the f-file and central diagonals.

BRANCH LOGIC 03

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Against f5, stop the pawn chain from rolling before adding b3.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

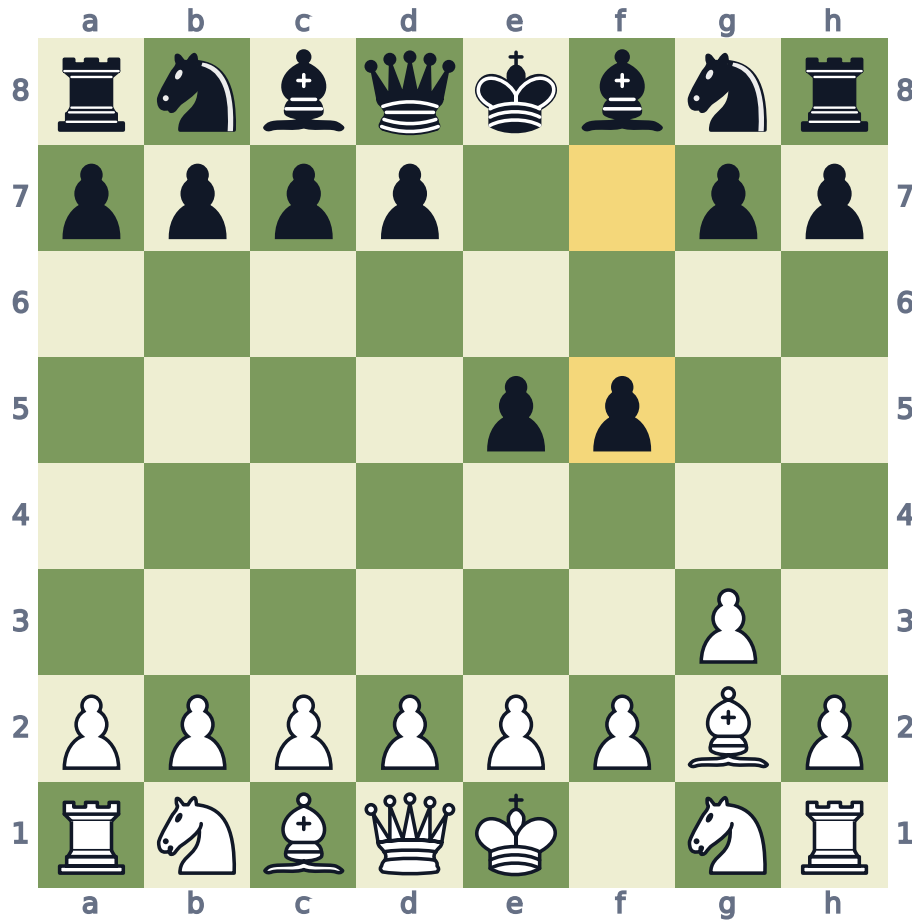
Position estimate: +0.00 for White (equal). Principal continuation: 1. fxe4 dxe4 2. Be6 b3 3. Qd7 c4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 03

Early f5 with e4 restraint



YOUR TASK

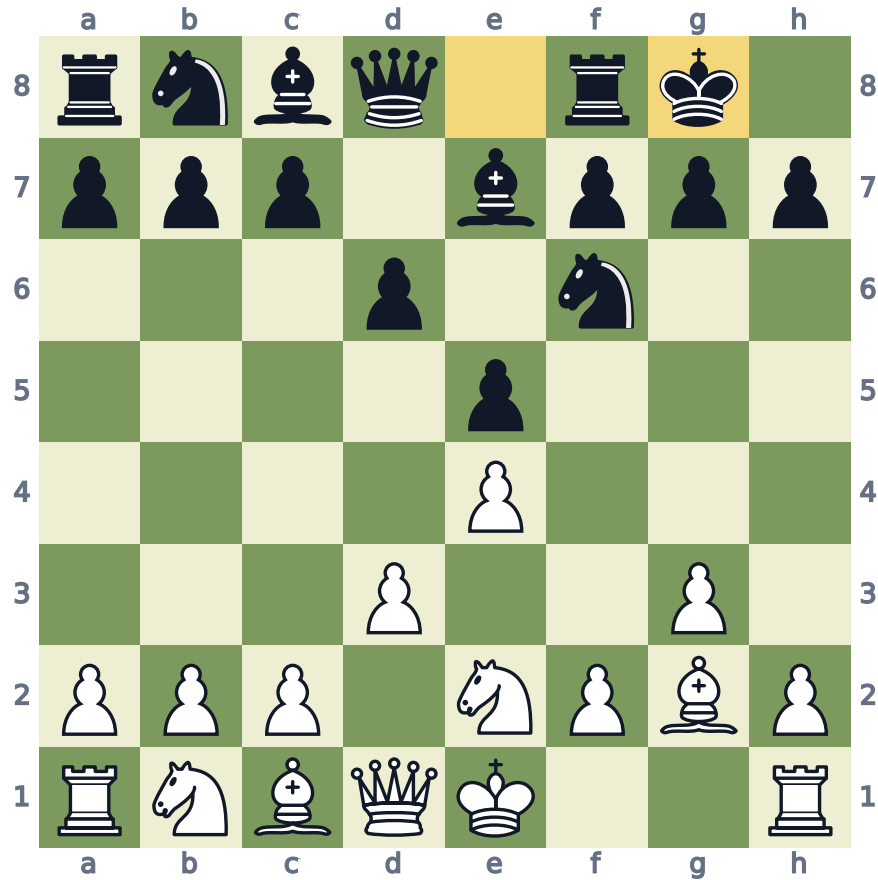
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 04

e5-d6 compact center



COURSE LINE

1. g3 e5 2. Bg2 d6 3. d3 Nf6 4. e4 Be7 5. Ne2 O-O

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

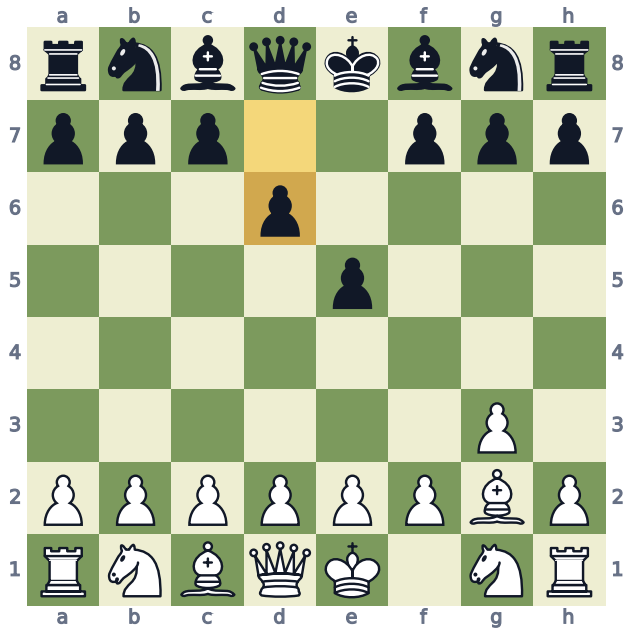
Claim e4 and complete development before deciding f4 or d4.

MAIN DANGER

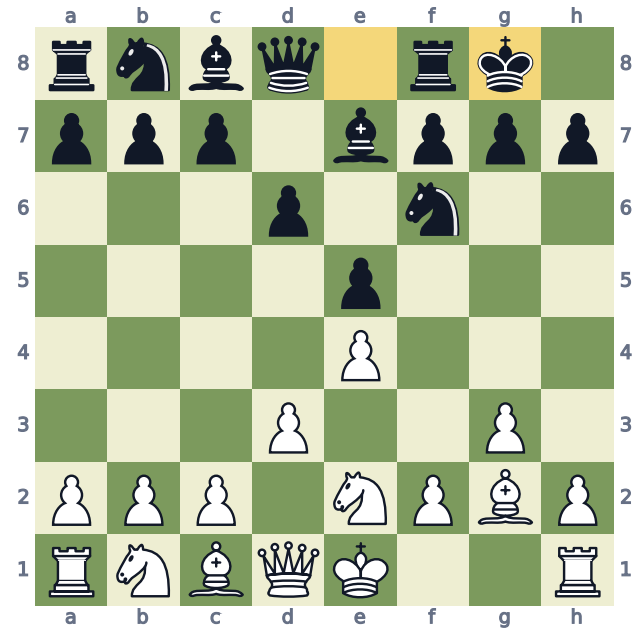
d5 can close the center and give Black a King's Indian plan.

BRANCH LOGIC 04

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

A compact black center permits e4, but the next break still matters.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

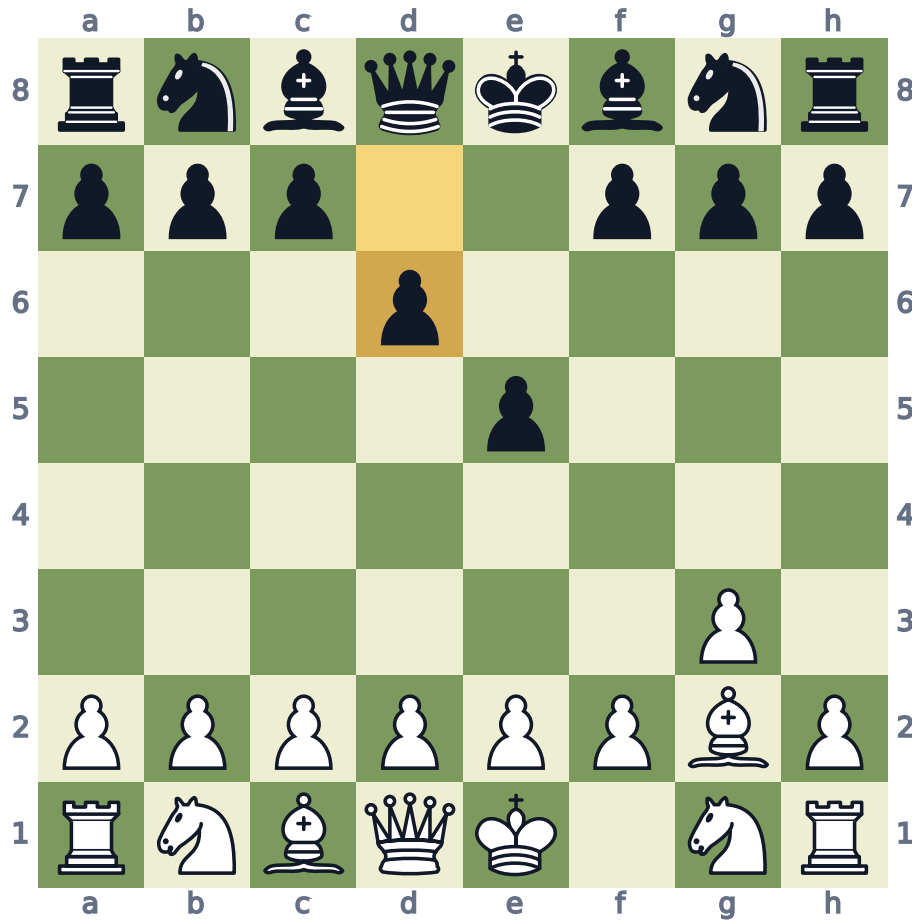
Position estimate: +0.33 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. c4 c6 2. O-O b5 3. cxb5 cxb5 4. Na3 b4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 04

e5-d6 compact center



YOUR TASK

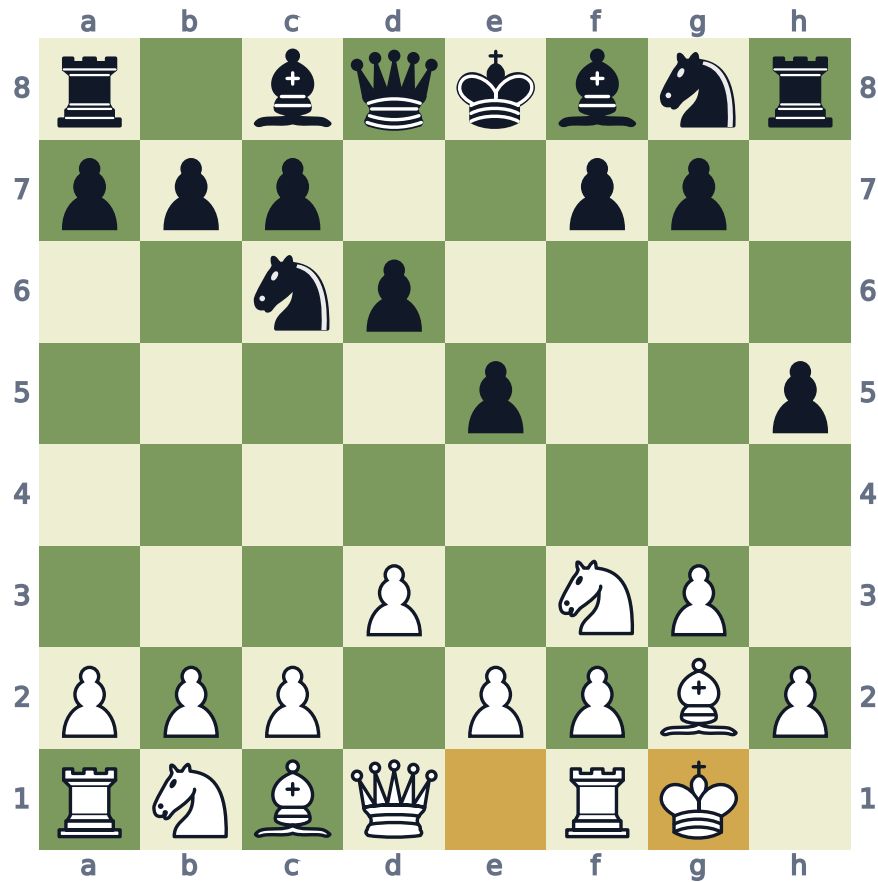
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 05

e5 with h5



COURSE LINE

1. g3 e5 2. Bg2 Nc6 3. d3 h5 4. Nf3 d6 5. O-O

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

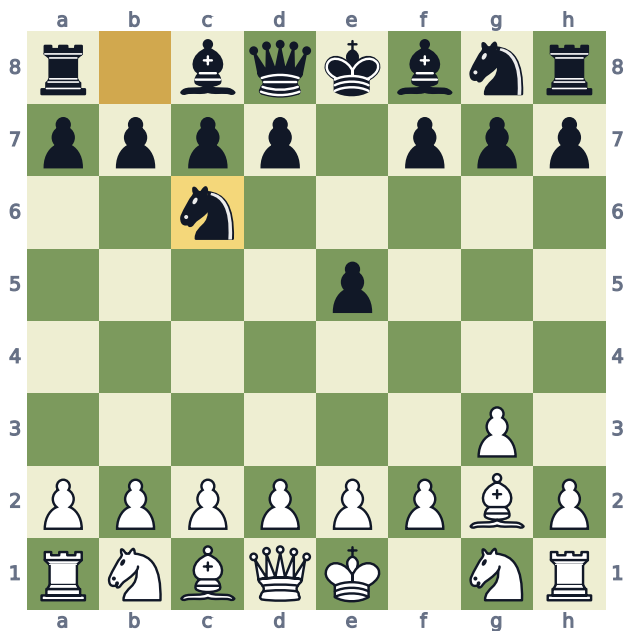
Castle and meet the wing pawn with development and central play.

MAIN DANGER

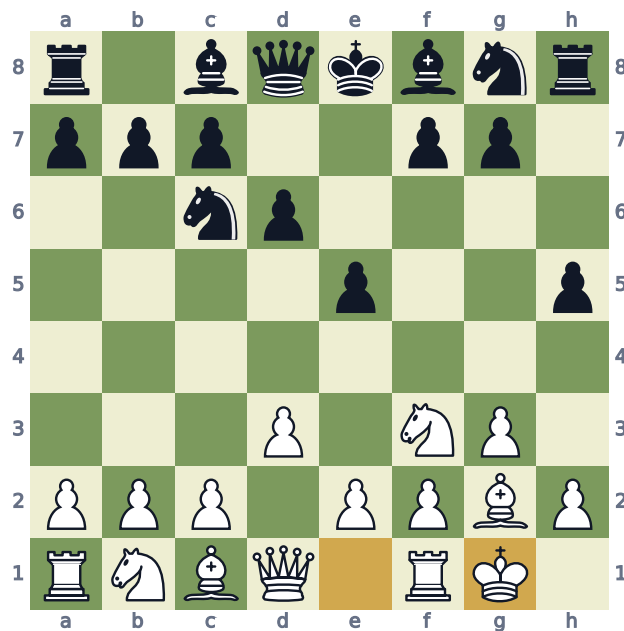
h4 can cramp the kingside or provoke a weakening capture.

BRANCH LOGIC 05

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Do not answer a wing pawn until it creates a concrete threat.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

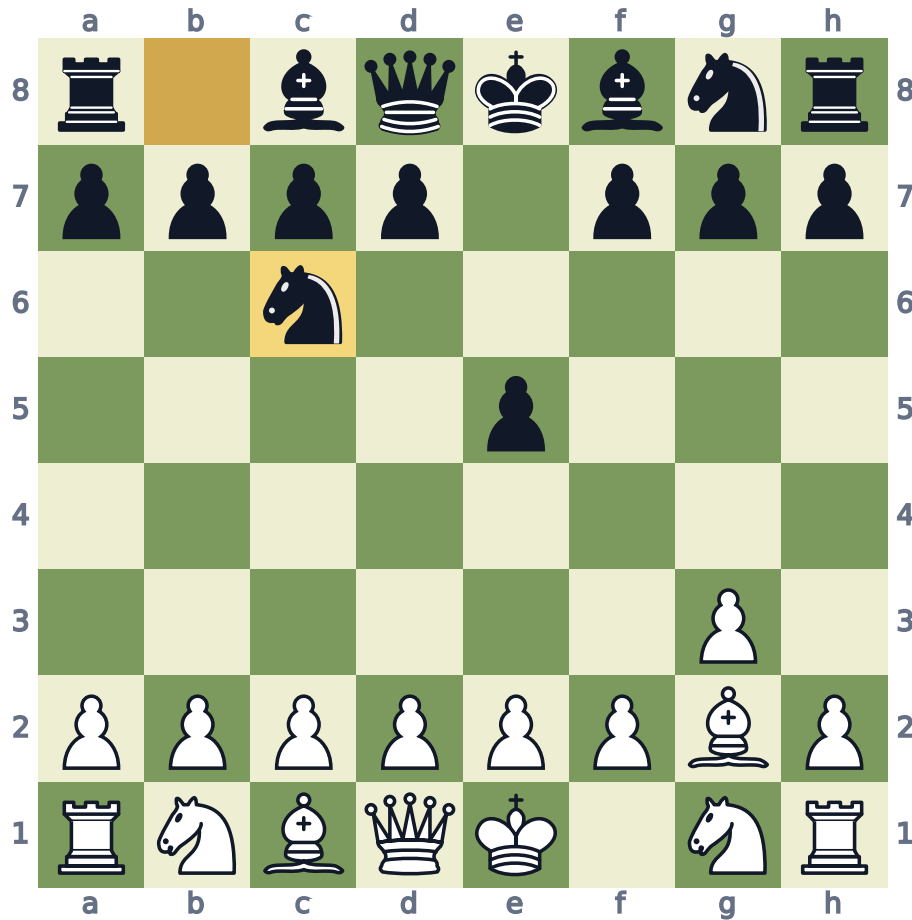
Position estimate: +0.26 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. h4 c4 2. h3 Bh1 3. Be7 Nc3 4. a5 b3 5. Nf6 Bb2

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 05

e5 with h5



YOUR TASK

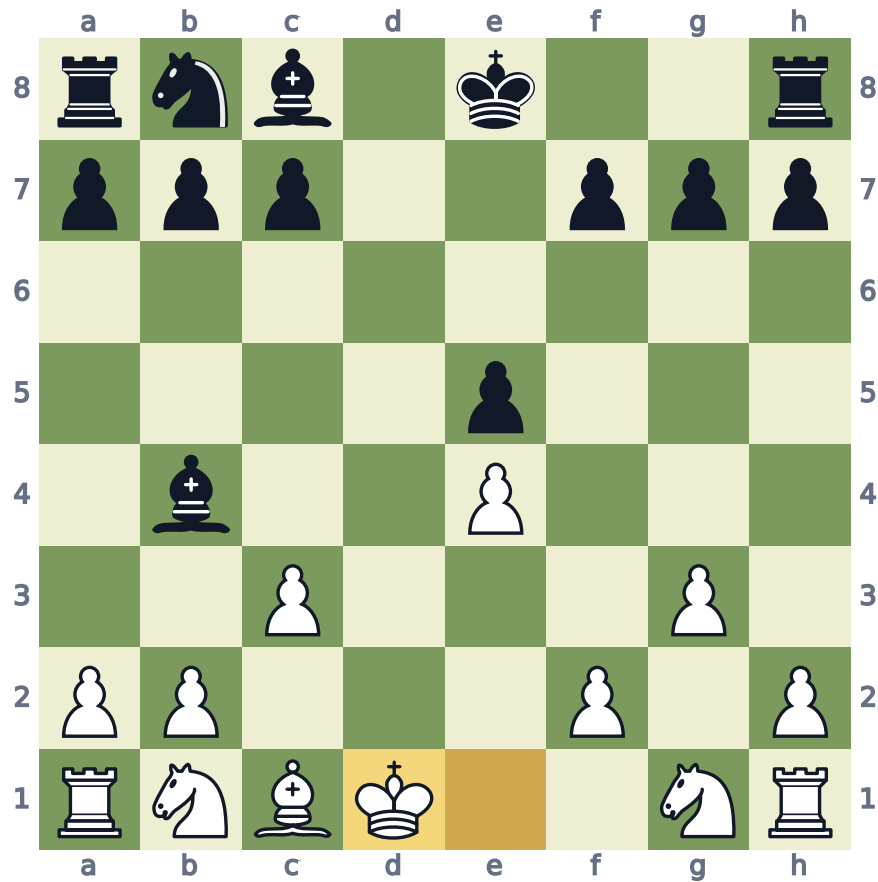
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 06

Open contact on e4



COURSE LINE

1. g3 e5 2. Bg2 d5 3. d3 Nf6 4. e4 dxe4 5. Bxe4 Bb4+ 6. c3 Nxe4 7. dxe4 Qxd1+ 8. Kxd1

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Use Bxe4, meet the check, and accept the forced queen exchange without losing material.

MAIN DANGER

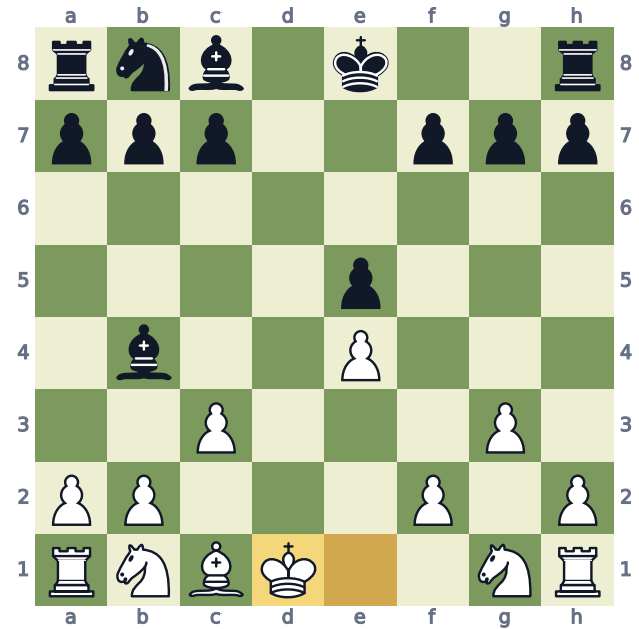
The open d-file costs castling rights and leaves a technical middlegame.

BRANCH LOGIC 06

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

When the d-file opens, calculate the complete queen-exchange sequence.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -1.39 for White (Black is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bc5 Nf3 2. Bg4 Ke2 3. f5 h3 4. Bh5 exf5 5. O-O Nd2

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 06

Open contact on e4



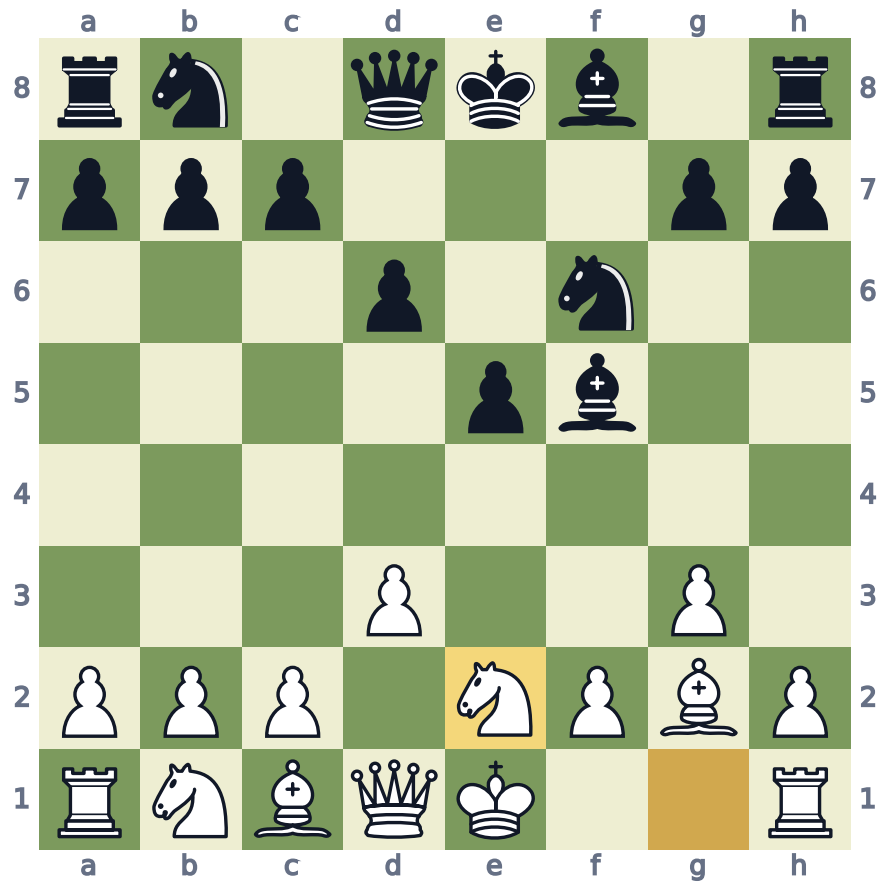
YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

Accept the early f-pawn target



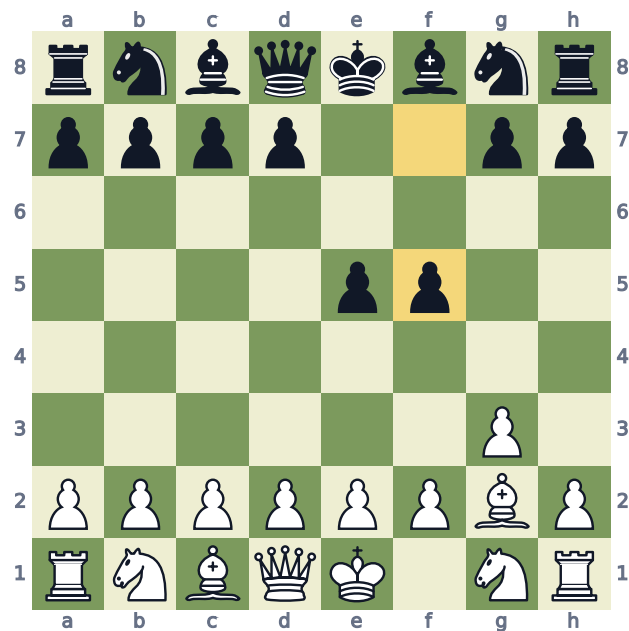
1. g3 e5 2. Bg2 f5 3. d3 Nf6 4. e4 d6 5. exf5 Bxf5 6. Ne2

Exchange on f5 when it weakens Black's center and gains development targets.

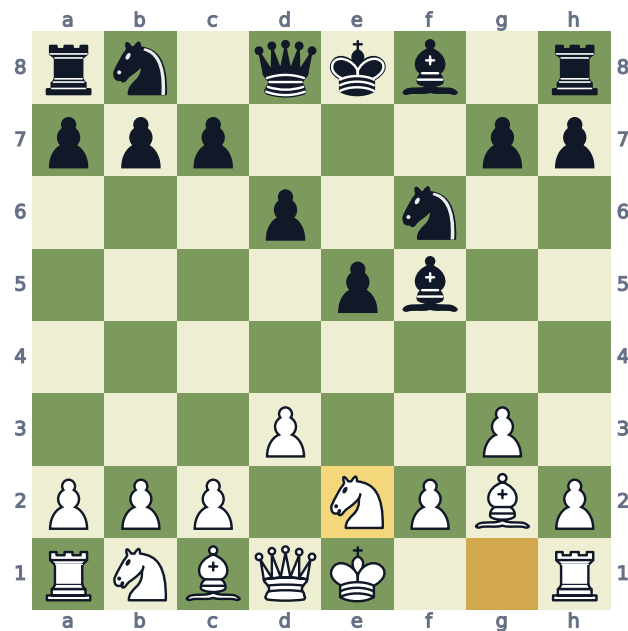
Black may use d5 and Nc6 for quick activity.

BRANCH LOGIC 07

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Winning a pawn is secondary to completing development.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

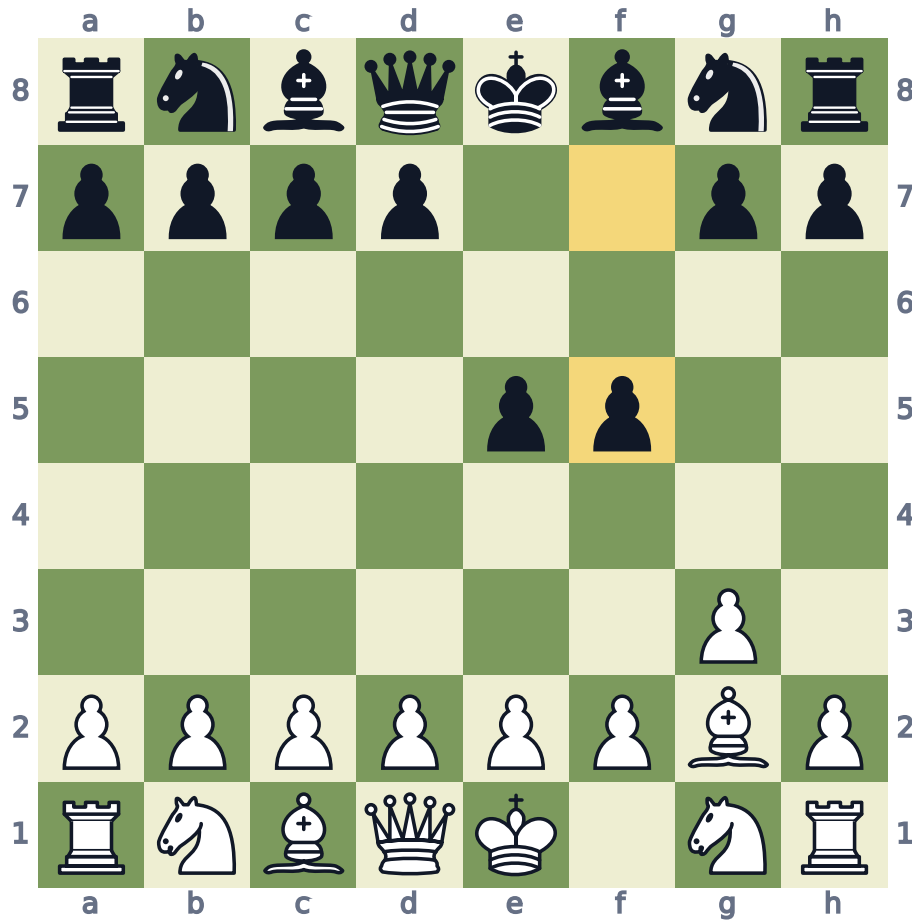
Position estimate: -0.38 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nc6 O-O 2. Qd7 d4 3. Bh3 Bg5 4. Bxg2 Kxg2

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 07

Accept the early f-pawn target



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 08

Meet Bb4 pressure



COURSE LINE

1. g3 e5 2. Bg2 Nf6 3. d3 d5 4. Nd2 Bb4 5. c3 Bd6 6. e4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

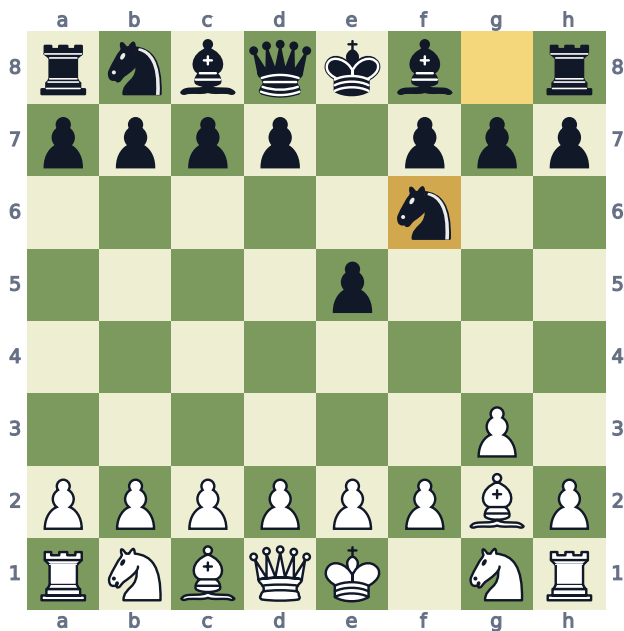
Question the bishop and build e4 without allowing a damaging pin.

MAIN DANGER

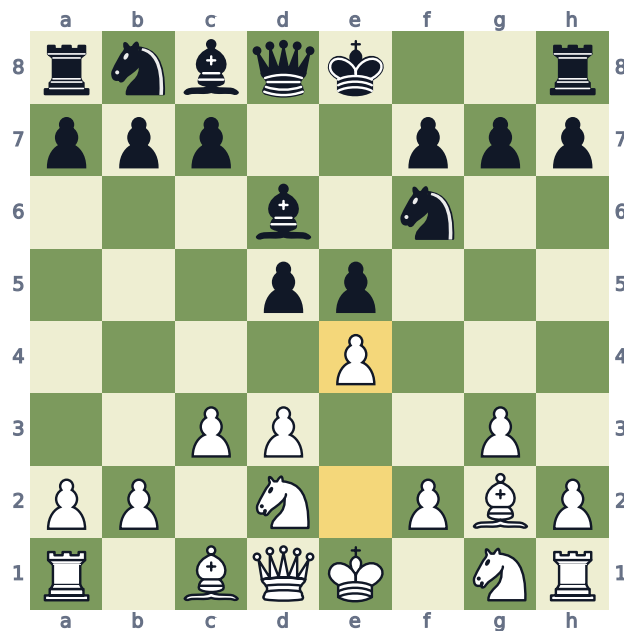
d4 can gain space after c3 blocks the knight.

BRANCH LOGIC 08

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

A pin is urgent only when it supports a central tactic.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

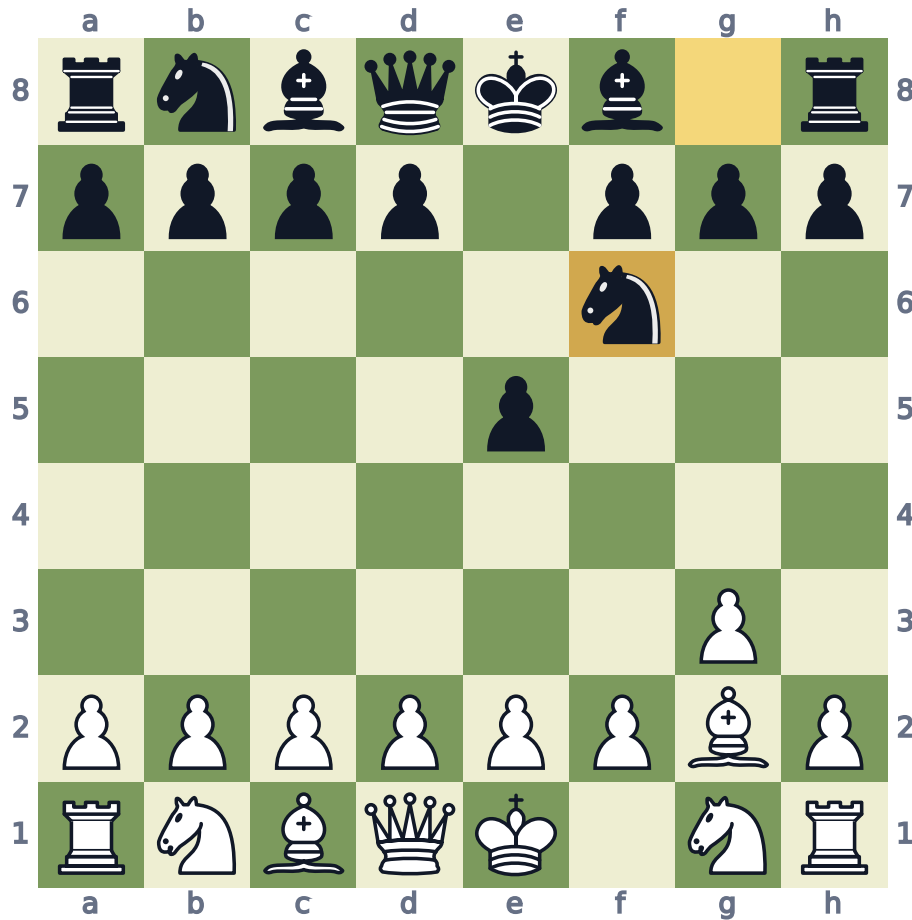
Position estimate: -0.19 for White (equal). Principal continuation: 1. dxe4 dxe4 2. O-O Ngf3 3. b5 O-O 4. a5 Nh4 5. Re8 Nf5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 08

Meet Bb4 pressure



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

ANSWER SECTION

Recall solutions begin here

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not read a solution until you have committed to a move and purpose. A matching move without the correct reason earns partial credit. If the course move is not the engine's first choice, compare plans rather than treating the engine as a memorization oracle.

ERROR LABELS

M = move-order memory | T = tactical oversight | P = plan misunderstanding | V = visualization | C = calculation | R = rushed recognition

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce a question you can use in future games. Example: 'When Black supports d5 with c6, which pawn break or recovery method does my repertoire use?'

SOLUTIONS

Answers 1-3

01. SINGLE E5 WITH D4 CHALLENGE

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Prepare d4 and develop rapidly against a single central pawn. Engine comparison: 1. c4 d5 2. cxd5 Nxd5 3. Nc3 Be6 4. Nf3 Be7 5. O-O O-O (+0.01 for White (equal)). Warning: e4 can gain space if White delays.

02. BLACK DEVELOPS BC5

Course move: d3. Purpose: Prepare d4 without exposing the king to a central tactic. Engine comparison: 1. c4 d5 2. cxd5 Nxd5 3. Nf3 Nc6 4. O-O Nb6 5. Nc3 Be7 (+0.22 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Ng4 and d4 can create pressure before White castles.

03. EARLY F5 WITH E4 RESTRAINT

Course move: d3. Purpose: Use e4 to block the f-pawn's support and prepare f4 or exf5. Engine comparison: 1. e4 Nc6 2. exf5 Qf6 3. Nc3 Qxf5 4. Nf3 Nf6 5. O-O (+0.75 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: fxe4 can open the f-file and central diagonals.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 4-6

04. E5-D6 COMPACT CENTER

Course move: d3. Purpose: Claim e4 and complete development before deciding f4 or d4. Engine comparison: 1. d4 Be7 2. c4 exd4 3. Qxd4 Nf6 4. Nc3 (+0.41 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: d5 can close the center and give Black a King's Indian plan.

05. E5 WITH H5

Course move: d3. Purpose: Castle and meet the wing pawn with development and central play. Engine comparison: 1. c4 Nf6 2. Nc3 Bb4 3. Nf3 O-O 4. O-O Re8 5. d3 Bxc3 (+0.25 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: h4 can cramp the kingside or provoke a weakening capture.

06. OPEN CONTACT ON E4

Course move: e4. Purpose: Use Bxe4, meet the check, and accept the forced queen exchange without losing material. Engine comparison: 1. c4 c6 2. Nf3 Bd6 3. O-O h6 4. Nc3 (-0.22 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: The open d-file costs castling rights and leaves a technical middlegame.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 7-8

07. ACCEPT THE EARLY F-PAWN TARGET

Course move: d3. Purpose: Exchange on f5 when it weakens Black's center and gains development targets. Engine comparison: 1. e4 Nc6 2. exf5 Qf6 3. Nc3 Qxf5 4. Nf3 Nf6 5. O-O (+0.75 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Black may use d5 and Nc6 for quick activity.

08. MEET BB4 PRESSURE

Course move: d3. Purpose: Question the bishop and build e4 without allowing a damaging pin. Engine comparison: 1. c4 d5 2. cxd5 Nxd5 3. Nf3 Nc6 4. O-O Nb6 5. Nc3 Be7 (+0.22 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: d4 can gain space after c3 blocks the knight.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.